

TaiwanEats

Product Requirements Document

Field	Details
Product Name	TaiwanEats
Version	1.0 — MVP
Author	TaiwanEats Founding Team
Date	May 28, 2026
Status	Draft
Platform	Web (Next.js / Vercel)
Target Markets	English-speaking global + Taiwan locals

1. Product Overview

TaiwanEats is a bilingual (English/Chinese) food guide website targeting both international travelers visiting Taiwan and Taiwanese locals seeking curated food discovery. The platform fills a critical gap between shallow English-language travel blogs and Chinese-only local platforms — offering deep-dive, SEO-optimized food content with a strong editorial voice and clear monetization through affiliate partnerships, advertising, and digital products.

1.1 Problem Statement

Travelers visiting Taiwan face a fragmented, low-quality information landscape:

- English content about Taiwan food is shallow — mostly generic listicles from one-time visitors
- Chinese-language platforms (iFoodie, iFood) are inaccessible to foreign visitors
- Google Maps lacks editorial context and bilingual support
- No single destination covers dishes, cities, night markets, and bookable experiences in one place

1.2 Solution

A content-first food guide built around three pillars: depth, bilingual accessibility, and local authenticity. Every guide includes Chinese dish names, ordering tips, maps, and affiliate-linked booking options so users can go from discovery to action in one visit.

1.3 Vision Statement

"The definitive English-language guide to eating extraordinary in Taiwan."

2. Goals & Success Metrics

Metric	Baseline	6-Month Target	12-Month Target
Monthly organic visitors	0	10,000	50,000
Published articles	0	60	150
Email subscribers	0	500	3,000
Monthly affiliate revenue	\$0	\$500	\$3,000+
Domain rating (Ahrefs)	0	15	30
Avg. session duration	—	2:30 min	3:30 min

3. Target Audience

3.1 Primary — International Travelers

- English-speaking tourists planning or on a trip to Taiwan
- High purchase intent: actively looking to book tours, accommodation, experiences
- Pain point: can't read Chinese, overwhelmed by generic travel content
- Monetization: Klook affiliate, Agoda/Booking.com, food tour bookings

3.2 Secondary — Taiwanese Diaspora

- Overseas Taiwanese craving connection to home food culture
- Interested in recipes, ingredient sourcing, restaurant recommendations in their city
- Monetization: digital products, specialty food affiliate links

3.3 Tertiary — Taiwan Locals

- Locals who prefer bilingual content or want to discover less-known gems
- Useful for recommending to foreign friends visiting
- Monetization: sponsored local restaurant content

4. Feature Requirements

4.1 MVP Features (Launch — Month 1)

Feature	Description	Priority
Homepage	Hero, category nav, featured articles, city cards, newsletter CTA	P0
Article pages	MDX-based articles with SEO metadata, bilingual dish names	P0
Dish guide index	Browsable list of all dish guides	P0
City guide index	Taipei, Tainan, Taichung, Kaohsiung landing pages	P0
Night market index	Market pages with schedules, maps, what-to-eat lists	P0
Newsletter signup	Email capture integrated with Mailchimp/Resend	P0
Mobile responsive	Fully optimised for mobile (60%+ of traffic)	P0
SEO metadata	OpenGraph, title tags, meta descriptions on all pages	P0
Affiliate links	Klook + Agoda links integrated into relevant articles	P1
Search	Basic search across articles and dishes	P1

4.2 Post-MVP Features (Month 2–6)

- Interactive night market map with filter by day/location
- Restaurant finder with Google Maps embed
- Bilingual toggle (English / Traditional Chinese)
- User-submitted tips and comments on articles
- Food experience booking page (aggregated Klook listings)
- "Food itinerary" generator by city and trip length

4.3 Future / V2 Features

- iOS/Android app (React Native)
- Community forum for travelers to ask food questions
- Paid membership tier with exclusive guides and discounts

- Video content (YouTube / Instagram Reels integration)

5. Technical Architecture

Layer	Choice
Framework	Next.js 14 (App Router)
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Language	TypeScript
Content	MDX files (local) → migrate to CMS later
CMS (Phase 2)	Sanity.io or Contentlayer
Hosting	Vercel (free tier to start)
Database	None at MVP — static content only
Email	Resend or Mailchimp for newsletter
Analytics	Vercel Analytics + Google Search Console
Images	Next.js Image component + Cloudinary (Phase 2)
Search	Algolia (Phase 2)

6. Monetization Strategy

6.1 Revenue Streams

Stream	How It Works	Est. Commission	Timeline
Klook Affiliate	Link to food tours & experiences in articles	3–8% per booking	Month 1
Agoda / Booking	Hotel affiliate links in city guides	4–6% per booking	Month 1
Google AdSense	Display ads once traffic reaches threshold	~\$5–15 RPM	Month 3
Sponsored posts	Paid restaurant / brand features	\$200–\$1,000/post	Month 6
Digital products	PDF itineraries, food bucket lists	\$9–\$29/item	Month 6
Newsletter ads	Sponsored slots in weekly email	\$50–\$300/issue	Month 9

7. Content Strategy

7.1 Content Pillars

- Dish Guides — deep dives on individual Taiwanese dishes with history, how to order, where to eat
- City Guides — Taipei, Tainan, Taichung, Kaohsiung neighborhood-by-neighborhood food maps
- Night Market Guides — schedules, maps, must-eat stalls, practical navigation tips
- Experience Guides — food tours, cooking classes, tea ceremonies, farm visits
- Practical Info — dietary restrictions, food vocabulary, etiquette, ordering tips

7.2 SEO Target Keywords (High Priority)

- best beef noodle soup taipei
- what to eat in taiwan
- taiwan night market guide
- what to eat in tainan
- taiwan food tour
- taiwanese breakfast food
- shilin night market guide
- bubble tea taiwan how to order

7.3 Publishing Cadence

- Month 1–3: 3 articles/week (focus: high-traffic evergreen keywords)
- Month 4–6: 2 articles/week (quality over volume, update existing posts)
- Month 7+: 1–2 articles/week + quarterly content audits

8. Go-to-Market Plan

Phase 1 — Foundation (Month 1)

- Publish 10 cornerstone articles targeting top keywords
- Set up Instagram with bilingual food content
- Register with Klook and Agoda affiliate programs
- Launch email list with free 'Taiwan Food Bucket List' PDF lead magnet

Phase 2 — Growth (Month 2–3)

- Publish 2–3x per week, focus on night markets and city guides
- Submit sitemap to Google Search Console
- Guest post on 3–5 travel blogs for backlinks
- Post dish explainer threads on Reddit (r/travel, r/taiwan, r/asianeats)

Phase 3 — Monetize (Month 4–6)

- Apply for Google AdSense once traffic reaches 10K monthly sessions
- Pitch first sponsored content partnership to a food tour operator
- Launch first paid digital product (city food itinerary PDF)
- Begin weekly newsletter with curated food tips

9. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
SEO takes longer than expected	Medium	Focus on long-tail keywords early; build backlinks via Reddit and guest posts
Content becomes stale (restaurants close)	Medium	Quarterly content audit; add 'last updated' dates to all articles
Low affiliate conversion rates	Low	A/B test CTA placement; add booking widgets inline, not just sidebar
Photography quality is poor	Medium	Invest in mirrorless camera early; partner with local food photographer
Competitor enters the space	Low	Build brand loyalty through voice and community before scale matters

10. Roadmap Timeline

Milestone	Deliverable	Notes
Week 1–2	Site live on Vercel	Domain, hosting, Next.js scaffold deployed
Week 3–4	10 articles published	Cornerstone SEO content, affiliate links live
Month 2	Social presence	Instagram + newsletter launched, 100 subscribers

Month 3	SEO traction	First Google rankings, 1,000+ monthly visitors
Month 4	First revenue	Klook affiliate commissions, AdSense approved
Month 6	Monetization diversified	Sponsored post, first digital product sold
Month 12	Established brand	50K monthly visitors, \$3K+/month revenue